

Verses of Auspiciousness of the Three Jewels

Ratnatrimaṅgalagāthā · Toh 824 · Derge Kangyur

དཀའ་ལྷོ་མཆོག་གསུམ་གྱི་ཀུན་གྱི་ཕྱི་སྐྱོ་སྐྱོ་སྐྱོ་པ།

This short text, known in Sanskrit as the Ratnatrimaṅgalagāthā and in Tibetan as Dkon mchog gsum gyi bkra shis kyi tshigs su bcad pa, or "Verses of Auspiciousness of the Three Jewels" in English, is a devotional liturgical poem invoking blessings and good fortune through praise of the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Sangha. Structured as a series of verses each culminating in the refrain calling for auspiciousness, it praises the Buddha's triumph over samsara and perfection of merit and wisdom, and by implication extends similar praise to the qualities of the Dharma and the Sangha as embodiments of the awakened path. Such auspiciousness verses belong to a genre widely used in ritual and ceremonial contexts to invoke blessings at the outset or conclusion of religious activities. This text is catalogued as Toh 824 in the Kangyur, situated among the shorter ritual and dedicatory verse compositions attributed to the broader tantric and devotional literature of the collection.

Here ends the glorious auspiciousness of the three families.

In the language of India: Ratnatrimaṅgalagāthā. In the language of Tibet: Verses of Auspiciousness of the Three Jewels.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

Victorious over the mire of saṃsāra, so hard to cross, like an ocean,
who has completed, without exception, the two accumulations of merit and wisdom, so difficult to gather,
the Tathāgata who has become the sole kinsman of all beings —
by that sacred auspiciousness, may there be goodness and excellence here today.

Having abandoned self-interest and always taking to heart the welfare of others,
keeping the view held far distant from the five qualities of desire,
embracing faith and diligence — the supreme friend, the awakening mind —
by that sacred auspiciousness, may there be goodness and excellence here today.

Free of arising and ceasing, having abandoned entirely the bonds of conceptual thought,

the supreme lamp of emptiness that destroys the darkness of ignorance,
the Dharma that accomplishes the bliss of the path, free of every kind of
conceptual object —

by that sacred auspiciousness, may there be goodness and excellence here
today.

The Verses of Auspiciousness of the Three Jewels.

Translator's Notes

- The text appears truncated at the end, breaking off mid-colophon after repeating the title; the expected concluding verse dedicated to the Saṅgha (to complete the "Three Jewels" theme) is absent from this passage, likely due to the source being incomplete. The opening line about "the three families" belongs to a separate, preceding text and is only the tail end of its colophon.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.